

cancellation technology.

Toshiba's TC94B24WBG single-chip audio codec does away with the need for separate speaker, headphone and line-out amplifiers. It features integrated audio post-processing support along with a programmable digital signal processor. The chip is said to support single microphone noise and echo cancellation during phone calls, and equaliser and dynamic range control during audio playback, the report added.

World's first ATM with intelligent power management system

Diebold has announced launch of the world's first automated teller machine (ATM) with intelligent power management system, Diebold 429. This machine is specifically designed to meet the increasing demand for a robust self-service terminal in urban and rural areas of India.

It has been built with a unique intelligent power management system wherein it automatically switches between three possible power sources (solar panel, alternating current (AC) grid and internal battery), maximising terminal uptime, lowering total cost of ownership and delivering unprecedented convenience to consumers.

A cuddle jacket is here

Getting a hug from a loved one is therapeutic. But having a loved one close by each time is practically not possible. However, a Singapore-based firm has come up with a good alternative for that. The firm has unveiled a 'cuddle jacket' at technology show CeBIT 2013.

A PTI report termed the 'cuddle jacket' as a normal-looking fleece-like item. The jacket has small air bubbles. Once inflated, these bubbles simulate the feeling of a cuddle, said James Teh, founder, T-ware. The jacket can be controlled by your smartphone and you can also modify the type of cuddle as per your mood.

Teh told AFP, "We believe this is the first wearable technology in the world for children with sensory disorders." The jacket is currently being retailed for \$ 499 (380 euros).

Device to reduce food wastage

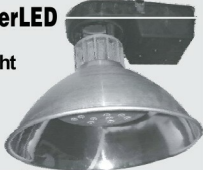
Researchers at the Eindhoven University of Technology in the Netherlands, Università di Catania in Italy, CEA-Liten and ST-Microelectronics have invented a plastic analogue-digital converter (ADC) that can greatly reduce food waste worldwide.

Millions of tons of food get wasted each year because the 'best before' date has passed. But this date is always a cautious estimate, which means a lot of still-edible food is thrown away. Wouldn't it be great if the packaging could 'test' whether the contents are still safe to eat?

Scientists said the new electronic device brings plastic sensor circuits costing less than one euro cent within reach. Beyond food, these ultra-low-cost plastic circuits have numerous potential uses, including pharmaceutical. The invention was presented recently at the ISSCC in San Francisco.

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